

FULL-DAY EMERGENCY SUB PLANS

VOLUME 1

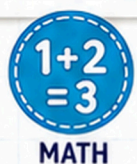
3
FULL DAYS

THREE WHOLE DAYS

Complete elementary sub plans for grades 1 and 2.
Built around a read-aloud, for children
who cannot yet work alone.



- ✓ Three complete school days, arrival to dismissal
- ✓ A read-aloud story for every day, printed in full
- ✓ Word work, writing, math and science every day
- ✓ Short blocks and built-in movement breaks
- ✓ Handwriting lines, drawing space and answer keys



DIGITAL VECTOR

Grades 1-2 • 62 pages • digitalvector.com.au

How This Pack Works

START HERE

Most sub plans hand a substitute a worksheet. In grades 1 and 2 that fails within ten minutes, because the children cannot read the instructions and cannot work alone for long enough.

This pack is built the way the day actually runs at this age. A read-aloud on the carpet, short blocks, a movement break between most of them, and student pages with very few words on them.

What is different about a grades 1 to 2 pack

WHY IT MATTERS	
The story is read to them	The full text is printed for the substitute, with marked places to stop and ask a question. Children this age get their comprehension through listening, not reading.
Blocks are short	Roughly twenty to thirty minutes, because that is genuinely as long as a six or seven year old concentrates. There is a movement break between most of them.
The substitute talks constantly	The script pages are longer than the pages the children get. That is the correct way round for this age.
Student pages have almost no text	Numbered instruction strips, big type, drawing boxes, and handwriting lines with a dashed midline.
Math is concrete	Ten frames, number lines and real shapes, not bare number sentences.

SIXTEEN PAGES PER DAY. ELEVEN TO COPY, FIVE TO KEEP.

Copy each day as one stapled packet. Hand it out in the morning and the children work through it in order. Handing out separate sheets all day is where an unfamiliar class comes apart.

The substitute keeps the Day at a Glance page, the carpet script, the read-aloud story, and the two answer keys.

Will a substitute cope with this?

That is the question this pack is built to answer. Every block the substitute leads has the words to say printed out. The read-aloud has the whole story and the questions. The math teaching page tells them what to say out loud and what to do when a child is stuck. There is a page on holding a class you have never met, and a bank of things to do when a gap opens up.

None of it assumes any early-years training, and none of it assumes they have met your class before.

Substitute Quick Start

FOR THE SUBSTITUTE

If you have five minutes before the children arrive, read this page and nothing else.

IN THE FIRST FIVE MINUTES

1. Find the Day at a Glance page. Put it on the desk and leave it there.
2. Check the packets are copied. If not, copy the Morning Work page first and the rest while they work.
3. Write your name on the board.
4. Read the carpet script. Do not improvise the first minute.
5. Skim the read-aloud story so you are not seeing it for the first time in front of them.

The shape of every day in this pack

ROUGHLY	WHAT HAPPENS
Arrival	Morning work at desks. Tracing and counting. You take attendance while they work.
Carpet	Ten minutes. Introduce yourself, teach your quiet signal, say what happens before recess.
Read aloud	Fifteen minutes on the carpet, then drawing and one sentence at desks.
Morning blocks	Word work, then writing, then math. A movement break between each.
Afternoon	Quiet time with books, then the science block read aloud together.
Last ten minutes	The How Was Today? sheet, then pack up.

THREE THINGS THAT MATTER MORE THAN THE LESSONS

Say what is next before every change. "When I count to five we are putting pencils down." Children this age are not being difficult at transitions. They do not know what is coming.

Ask them to show you the routines. Where they line up, how they hand things in, who sits where. They know, they love telling you, and it makes them your allies.

Praise out loud, correct quietly. Naming a child who is doing the right thing moves a whole room. Naming one who is not hands them an audience.

The Three Days

THE THREE DAYS

Each day is completely independent. Leave them in any order. No day assumes anything from another.

DAY	STORY	WORD WORK	WRITING	MATH
1	The Bear Who Woke Up Early	ea as in eat	Personal writing	Making ten
2	The Lost Mitten	sh, ch, th	Writing about kindness	Shapes and patterns
3	The Seed That Would Not Wait	-ain and -ake	How to plant a seed	Measuring and comparing

The read-aloud stories

DAY	THE STORY	WHAT IT IS REALLY ABOUT
1	The Bear Who Woke Up Early	A bear wakes in February by mistake and is rescued by a mouse who shares her food. Leads into hibernation.
2	The Lost Mitten	A lost mitten comes back mended, from somebody who never says who they are. Leads into materials and warmth.
3	The Seed That Would Not Wait	A seed pushes up too early, gets frosted, waits, and ends up tallest anyway. Leads into what plants need.

WHICH DAY SHOULD I LEAVE?

A class you do not know at all: Day 1. The story is the warmest of the three and the math is the most concrete.

You want work you can look at when you return: Day 3. The instruction writing shows you clearly who can sequence.

A restless group, or a Friday: Day 2. The shape hunt gets them up and moving with a purpose.

A NOTE ON THE READ-ALoud

The full text of each story is printed on the substitute's page, with three marked places to stop and ask a question. Children this age get their comprehension through listening, so the story is the biggest teaching block of the morning, not a warm-up.

Read it slowly. Take two or three answers at each stop and then carry on, however many hands are still up.

Class Information

TEACHER • FILL THIS IN ONCE AT THE START OF THE YEAR

Complete this once and it works for every absence after. In an infant classroom the substitute needs far more of this than in an older grade.

THE BASICS

My name and grade _____

Room number _____

Teach this day _____ Day _____ or any day from the index

Teacher next door _____

Office extension _____

Teaching assistant _____

THE DAY

Bell times _____

Recess and lunch _____

Specials today _____

Bathroom routine

Do they go alone or in pairs? _____

Where the class lines up _____

Carpet spots

Assigned or free? _____

Fire drill point _____

THE CHILDREN

Collected by an adult?

Who, and any custody notes _____

Medical, allergies, medication _____

Accommodations _____

Children who find change hard

The most useful line on this page _____

Children who can help you _____

Holding a Class You Do Not Know

SUBSTITUTE · KEEP THIS PAGE

SIX AND SEVEN YEAR OLDS ARE NOT TESTING YOU ON PURPOSE

They are checking what the rules are with a new adult, which is a sensible thing for a small person to do. Being warm and completely predictable settles a room faster than being strict.

Say this instead of that

INSTEAD OF	TRY
"Be quiet!"	"Show me listening ears." Then wait. Do not repeat it.
"Sit down."	"Bottoms on the carpet, hands in your lap, eyes on me." Say all three parts.
"Who did that?"	"I am waiting for one more person." Never name a child in front of the class.
"Stop it."	"That is not a safe choice. Show me a safe choice." Then praise whoever does.
"Hurry up."	"I am counting to ten and then we are going." Then count. Out loud. Slowly.
"You should know this."	"Let me show you again." They might genuinely not know, and being told off for it stops them asking next time.

Five moves that work in any infant room

- **Teach a clap-back signal in the first ten minutes.** You clap a rhythm, they clap it back. Practice it once while everyone is calm.
- **Count down instead of asking twice.** "Pencils down in five, four, three..." moves a room faster than any instruction repeated.
- **Narrate what is going right.** "Table two is ready." The rest copy within seconds and nobody has been told off.
- **Give the busiest child a job.** Handing out packets, holding the door, being line leader. Redirection, not reward.
- **Get them up every twenty minutes.** Fidgeting is not misbehaviour at this age, it is a signal. The Brain Breaks page is at the back.

WHEN SOMETHING GOES PROPERLY WRONG

If a child is hurt, distressed, or a situation is beyond a normal classroom problem, send two children to the office or the teacher next door. Do not leave the class, and do not try to handle it alone because you want to seem capable.

Crying is common at this age and usually passes. Kneel down to their height, say what happens next, and give it two minutes before deciding it is serious.

What Is on Every Page

EVERY PAGE IN THIS PACK

Eleven pages per day are copied for children. Five are kept by the substitute, because at this age the adult needs more paper than the class does.

PAGE	WHAT IT IS	CONTENTS
1-7	Getting started	Cover, how the pack works, substitute quick start, the three days, class information, holding a class you do not know, this page
8-9	Day 1 scripts	Day at a Glance and the carpet script. <i>Substitute keeps these.</i>
11	Day 1 read-aloud	The full story with marked places to stop and ask. <i>Substitute keeps this.</i>
10-21	Day 1 student pages	Morning work, after the story, ea as in eat, writing, making ten, hibernation, and How Was Today? Eleven pages to copy.
22-23	Day 1 answer keys	Every answer with marking notes. <i>Substitute keeps these.</i>
24-25	Day 2 scripts	Day at a Glance and the carpet script. <i>Substitute keeps these.</i>
27	Day 2 read-aloud	The full story with marked places to stop and ask. <i>Substitute keeps this.</i>
26-37	Day 2 student pages	Morning work, after the story, sh, ch, th, writing, shapes and patterns, materials and warmth, and How Was Today? Eleven pages to copy.
38-39	Day 2 answer keys	Every answer with marking notes. <i>Substitute keeps these.</i>
40-41	Day 3 scripts	Day at a Glance and the carpet script. <i>Substitute keeps these.</i>
43	Day 3 read-aloud	The full story with marked places to stop and ask. <i>Substitute keeps this.</i>
42-53	Day 3 student pages	Morning work, after the story, -ain and -ake, writing, measuring and comparing, what plants need, and How Was Today? Eleven pages to copy.
54-55	Day 3 answer keys	Every answer with marking notes. <i>Substitute keeps these.</i>
56-60	The filler banks	Time fillers, brain breaks, wet-weather games, a fast finisher menu, and the substitute's note back
61-62	Reference	Standards alignment, terms of use and credits

THE FASTEST WAY TO USE THIS PACK

Photocopy the eleven student pages for one day as a single stapled packet. Put the five substitute pages on the desk in order. That is the whole preparation.

Day 1 at a Glance

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE ON YOUR DESK

THE WHOLE DAY, IN ONE TABLE

Times are a guide. Your school's bells win. The **Page** column tells you which sheet the children need in front of them.

Blocks are short on purpose. Children this age concentrate for about as many minutes as their age. Every block here is under thirty, and there is a movement break between most of them.

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT HAPPENS	PAGE
8:30	Arrival	Children come in and start Morning Work. Take attendance while they work.	p. 10
8:45	Carpet time	Read the script on the next page. Teach your quiet signal now.	keep
9:00	Read aloud	Read the story on the carpet. Stop at the orange boxes.	keep
9:20	After the story	Children draw and finish a sentence.	p. 12
9:40	Movement break	Two minutes. Use the Brain Breaks page.	back
9:45	Word work	Today's sound. Circle, then write.	p. 13
10:10	Recess	Ask a child to show you where the class lines up.	—
10:30	Writing	Say it first, then write. Two pages.	p. 14-15
11:05	Math	Read the teaching page together, then practice.	p. 16-17
11:40	Math game	Partners. Ten minutes.	p. 18
12:00	Lunch	Line them up three minutes early. It always takes longer than you think.	—
12:50	Quiet time	Children look at books at their desks. Do not expect silence.	—
1:10	Afternoon	Read the science page aloud together, then the task.	p. 19-20
1:50	Specials or filler	If there is no special, use the Time Filler Bank.	back
2:30	Closing	How Was Today? sheet, then pack up.	p. 21
2:50	Dismissal	Stack all work on the desk with the closing sheets on top.	—

IF YOU ARE RUNNING BEHIND

Cut the math game and quiet time first. Never cut the movement break, and never cut the closing sheet.

THE SINGLE MOST USEFUL THING YOU CAN DO

Say what is happening next, out loud, before every change. "When I count to five we are putting pencils down and coming to the carpet." Children this age are not being difficult at transitions. They genuinely do not know what is coming.

Carpet Time and First Moves

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

THE FIRST FIFTEEN MINUTES DECIDE THE DAY

You are a stranger and they will check what the rules are with you. Being warm and completely predictable is worth more than being strict.

On the carpet, ten minutes

SAY THIS TO START

Good morning everyone. My name is on the board. Your teacher is not here today, and she left me a plan for the whole day, so I know exactly what we are doing. First I am going to teach you my quiet signal. I clap like this, and you clap it back. Let us practice. Good. Now, this morning we have a story about a bear, some writing, and some counting. I do not know your names yet, so you will have to help me.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO	
1	Write your name on the board. Point at it and say it.
2	Teach the clap-back signal and practice it twice, now, while everyone is calm.
3	Read the script above. Do not improvise the first minute.
4	Ask: <i>what does this class always do at carpet time?</i> Take two answers. Children love correcting a substitute and this gives them a legitimate way to do it.
5	Say what happens before recess, in order, on your fingers.
6	Start the read-aloud straight away while they are settled.

Four things that work with this age

INSTEAD OF	TRY
"Be quiet!"	"Show me listening ears." Then wait. Do not repeat it.
"Sit down."	"Bottoms on the carpet, hands in your lap, eyes on me." Say all three.
"Who did that?"	"I am waiting for one more person." Never name a child in front of the class.
"Stop it."	"That is not a safe choice. Show me a safe choice." Then praise the child who does.

YOUR QUIET SIGNAL

Teach one in the first ten minutes and use it all day. A clap-back pattern works everywhere: you clap a short rhythm, they clap it back. Practice it once while everyone is calm and it will work when they are not.



- 1 Write your name at the top.
- 2 Trace the words. Say each one out loud.
- 3 Count and write the number.
- 4 Color the picture if you finish.

1. Trace and say

bear cave sleep

2. Count

How many counters? Write the number in the box.

●	●	●	●	●
●	●			

●	●	●	●	

3. FINISHED?

Color the counters you drew. Then put your pencil down and sit quietly until everyone is ready.

COLOR ME

Finish early? Color Bruno the bear and his winter cave.



Read Aloud: The Bear Who Woke Up Early

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD. KEEP THIS PAGE.

HOW TO READ IT

Children sit on the carpet. Read slowly. The **orange boxes** are places to stop and ask the question printed in them. Take two or three answers, then carry on. Do not stop anywhere else, however many hands go up.

The Bear Who Woke Up Early

Read-aloud story

Bruno the bear went to sleep in his cave when the first leaf fell. He curled up small. He put his nose under his paw. He slept and slept and slept.

Outside, the snow came. It covered the trees. It covered the river. It covered the door of the cave until only a little hole was left.

STOP AND ASK

What do you think will happen next?

One morning Bruno opened one eye. Something felt wrong. It was not warm and it was not dark. A thin line of light was coming through the hole.

Bruno pushed his nose outside. The air was cold. Very cold. But it smelled green.

"Spring!" said Bruno. "I have slept all winter and now it is spring!" And he pushed his way out of the cave, very pleased with himself.

It was not spring. It was the middle of February, and there was snow up to his knees.

STOP AND ASK

How do you think Bruno feels now?

Bruno sat down in the snow. He was cold. He was hungry. And he had a long way to go before the berries came back.

A small brown mouse popped up out of a hole. "You are early," said the mouse.

"I know," said Bruno.

"Go back to bed," said the mouse.

"I cannot," said Bruno. "I am awake now."

The mouse thought about this. Then she said, "Well. You will have to help me instead." And she took him to a place under a log where she had hidden more seeds than one mouse could ever eat.

They shared them. They waited together. And when the real spring came, Bruno had a friend.

STOP AND ASK

Why do you think the mouse helped Bruno?



1 Draw the part you liked best.

2 Finish the sentence underneath.

DRAW YOUR FAVORITE PART



Finish this sentence

My favorite part was when

TALK ABOUT IT

Turn to the person next to you. Tell them one thing Bruno did in the story. Then swap and listen to theirs.





- 1 Say each word out loud.
- 2 Circle the ones with the sound at the top.
- 3 Write two of your own on the lines.

TODAY'S SOUND

ea as in eat

Say each word slowly. Listen for the long e sound in the middle.

Circle the words with the sound

eat

cat

seat

bed

leaf

team

read

red

beach

Now write two of your own

FAST FINISHER

Find three more words with the **ea** sound somewhere in the room. Look at the labels and the books.





1 Look at the words you can use.

2 Say your sentence out loud first.

3 Then write it on the lines.

TODAY YOU ARE WRITING

Write about a time you woke up too early, or a time you did not want to get up.

Words you might need

woke

early

sleepy

cold

warm

morning

because

then

A sentence to start you off

One time I woke up



- 1 Draw your picture first.
- 2 Then write two or three sentences about it.
- 3 Check you used a capital letter and a full stop.

YOUR PICTURE

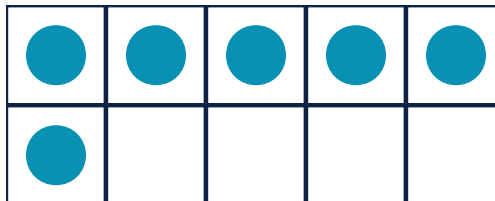
**BEFORE YOU HAND IT IN**

Point at your capital letter. Point at your full stop. Read your sentence out loud to someone at your table.



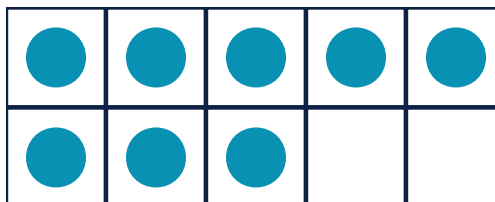
**SUBSTITUTE: READ THIS PART OUT LOUD**

We are going to make ten in lots of different ways. Ten is a very useful number because we have ten fingers, so you can always check.

Making Ten

6 counters. How many empty boxes?

$$6 + 4 = 10$$

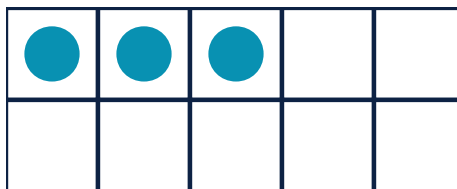


8 counters. How many empty boxes?

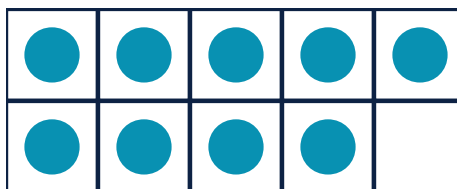
$$8 + 2 = 10$$

IF A CHILD IS STUCK

Give them their hands. Hold up the first number of fingers and count how many are still down. It works every time and it is not cheating.

Try these two together

$$3 + \underline{\quad} = 10$$



$$9 + \underline{\quad} = 10$$



- 1 Do them in order.
- 2 Use the pictures to help you.
- 3 Check your answers by counting again.

Fill in the missing number to make ten.

$$5 + __ = 10$$

$$2 + __ = 10$$

$$7 + __ = 10$$

$$1 + __ = 10$$

$$4 + __ = 10$$

$$10 + __ = 10$$

Now use the number line

Start at 6. Hop 4. Where do you land? Circle it.



Start at 3. Hop 5. Where do you land? Circle it.





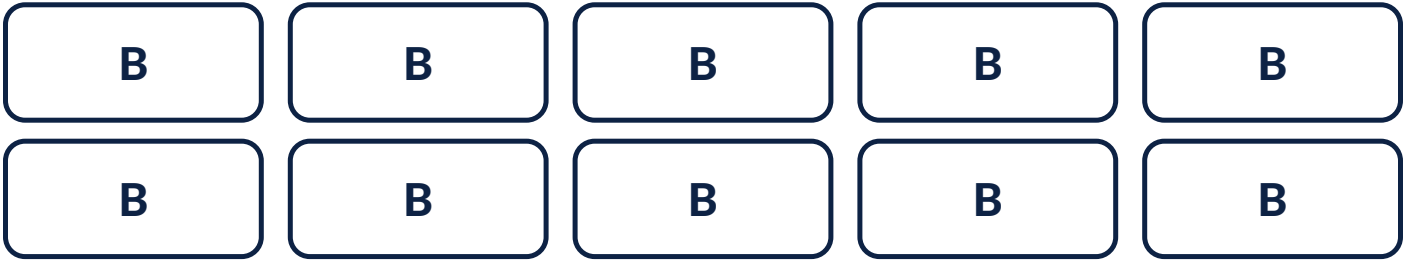
MATH GAME

HOW TO PLAY

Play with a partner. You need one pencil each and this page.

Ten in the Cave

1. Player one says a number from 1 to 9.
2. Player two says the number that makes ten.
3. If they are right, they color one bear. If not, the other player colors it.
4. Swap. First to color five bears wins.



Write down three pairs you used

FAST FINISHER

Can you find a pair that makes ten using three numbers instead of two? Write it down.



**SUBSTITUTE: READ THIS OUT LOUD TOGETHER**

Read one numbered part at a time. Ask the question at the end of each before moving on.

1. In winter there is less food. Berries are gone. Insects are hiding. Some animals have a clever answer: they go to sleep for months. This is called **hibernation**.

Ask: why is winter a hard time to find food?

2. Before winter, the animal eats and eats and gets fat. That fat is its food for the whole sleep. Bruno the bear did this before he went into his cave.

Ask: why does it need to get fat first?

3. While it sleeps, its heart beats very slowly and its body goes cold. It uses hardly any energy at all. That is how the fat lasts so long.

Ask: what would happen if it ran around all winter instead?

4. Not every animal does this. Some fly away to somewhere warm. Some stay awake and hunt. Some, like squirrels, hide food in the autumn and dig it up all winter.

Ask: which of those does the mouse in our story do?



1 Cut out the four animals at the bottom.

2 Sort them into the right box.

3 Draw one more animal in either box.

SLEEPS ALL WINTER	STAYS AWAKE
bear	squirrel
fox	hedgehog

Write one sentence

A bear sleeps all winter because

FAST FINISHER

Draw the inside of Bruno's cave. Show what he needs in there to last the whole winter.



- 1 Color the face that shows how today felt.
- 2 Draw one thing you did today.
- 3 Write your name so your teacher knows it is yours.

Great
day

Good
day

Tricky
day

One thing I did today

DRAW IT HERE



My name



Answer Key: Literacy

WORD WORK

Circle: eat, seat, leaf, team, read, beach. Not circled: cat, bed, red.

Own words: Any real word containing the sound. Invented spelling is fine at this age as long as the sound is there.

READ-ALOUD AND WRITING

Question 1: Open. Any prediction is a good one at this age. Accept everything and move on quickly.

Question 2: Look for: disappointed, sad, cold, silly, embarrassed. If a child says "happy", ask them to point to the part that shows it. That is the whole skill.

Question 3: Open. Strong answers: the mouse was kind; she had too much food; she wanted a friend too; she felt sorry for him.

MARKING THE WRITING IN TEN SECONDS

Look for three things and nothing else: a capital letter at the start, a full stop at the end, and a sentence that makes sense when read aloud.

Do not correct spelling. At this age, invented spelling that can be sounded out is exactly what should be happening, and correcting it stops children writing.

What good looks like in grades 1 and 2

	WORKING	NOT YET
Word work	Hears the sound in a word said aloud, even if the spelling is wrong	Circles by looking at the letters only, without saying the word
Writing	One clear sentence that makes sense read aloud	A list of words with no sentence, or a copied stem
Drawing	The picture matches what they wrote	The picture and the writing are about different things
Talking	Can retell one thing that happened in the story	Retells a different story, or their own news

IF A CHILD PRODUCED NOTHING AT ALL

Do not push. Write their name on the sheet, note one line on the substitute's page at the back, and move on. A child who freezes with a stranger in the room is telling you something, and it is not about the task.

Answer Key: Math and Afternoon

MATH

	ANSWER
5 + 5	10
2 + 8	10
7 + 3	10
1 + 9	10
4 + 6	10
10 + 0	10
Try A	3 + 7 = 10
Try B	9 + 1 = 10
Number line 1	Lands on 10
Number line 2	Lands on 8

Game: Number bonds to ten: 1+9, 2+8, 3+7, 4+6, 5+5, 6+4, 7+3, 8+2, 9+1. Three-number answers such as 2+3+5 are correct and worth praising.

AFTERNOON

Sort: **Sleeps all winter:** bear, hedgehog. **Stays awake:** squirrel, fox. Squirrels hide food and dig it up, which is in part 4.

Sentence: Look for the idea that there is no food in winter, or that sleeping saves energy. Do not correct spelling.

Question 3 (part 3): It would use up all its fat far too quickly and run out of food before spring.

LEAVE THIS FOR THE TEACHER

Stack the day's work on the desk with the How Was Today? sheets on top. Those tell the returning teacher more in four minutes than any of the work does.

Day 2 at a Glance

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE ON YOUR DESK

THE WHOLE DAY, IN ONE TABLE

Times are a guide. Your school's bells win. The **Page** column tells you which sheet the children need in front of them.

Blocks are short on purpose. Children this age concentrate for about as many minutes as their age. Every block here is under thirty, and there is a movement break between most of them.

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT HAPPENS	PAGE
8:30	Arrival	Children come in and start Morning Work. Take attendance while they work.	p. 26
8:45	Carpet time	Read the script on the next page. Teach your quiet signal now.	keep
9:00	Read aloud	Read the story on the carpet. Stop at the orange boxes.	keep
9:20	After the story	Children draw and finish a sentence.	p. 28
9:40	Movement break	Two minutes. Use the Brain Breaks page.	back
9:45	Word work	Two-letter sounds. Circle, then write.	p. 29
10:10	Recess	Ask a child where the class lines up.	—
10:30	Writing	Say it first, then write. Two pages.	p. 30-31
11:05	Math	Shapes and patterns. Teaching page, then practice.	p. 32-33
11:40	Math game	Partners. Ten minutes.	p. 34
12:00	Lunch	Line them up three minutes early.	—
12:50	Quiet time	Children look at books at their desks.	—
1:10	Afternoon	Read the science page aloud together, then the task.	p. 35-36
1:50	Specials or filler	If there is no special, use the Time Filler Bank.	back
2:30	Closing	How Was Today? sheet, then pack up.	p. 37
2:50	Dismissal	Stack all work on the desk with the closing sheets on top.	—

IF YOU ARE RUNNING BEHIND

Cut the math game and quiet time first. Keep the movement break and the closing sheet.

THE SINGLE MOST USEFUL THING YOU CAN DO

Say what is happening next, out loud, before every change. "When I count to five we are putting pencils down and coming to the carpet." Children this age are not being difficult at transitions. They genuinely do not know what is coming.

Carpet Time and First Moves

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

THE FIRST FIFTEEN MINUTES DECIDE THE DAY

You are a stranger and they will check what the rules are with you. Being warm and completely predictable is worth more than being strict.

On the carpet, ten minutes

SAY THIS TO START

Good morning everyone. My name is on the board. Your teacher is away today and left me a plan for the whole day, so I know exactly what we are doing. First, my quiet signal. I clap like this and you clap it back. Let us practice. Lovely. This morning we have a story about something lost in the snow, some writing, and some shapes. You will have to help me with your names.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO	
1	Write your name on the board. Point at it and say it.
2	Teach the clap-back signal and practice it twice now, while everyone is calm.
3	Read the script above exactly.
4	Ask: <i>what does this class always do at carpet time?</i> Take two answers only.
5	Say what happens before recess, in order, on your fingers.
6	Start the read-aloud while they are still settled.

Four things that work with this age

INSTEAD OF	TRY
"Be quiet!"	"Show me listening ears." Then wait. Do not repeat it.
"Sit down."	"Bottoms on the carpet, hands in your lap, eyes on me." Say all three.
"Who did that?"	"I am waiting for one more person." Never name a child in front of the class.
"Stop it."	"That is not a safe choice. Show me a safe choice." Then praise the child who does.

YOUR QUIET SIGNAL

Teach one in the first ten minutes and use it all day. A clap-back pattern works everywhere: you clap a short rhythm, they clap it back. Practice it once while everyone is calm and it will work when they are not.



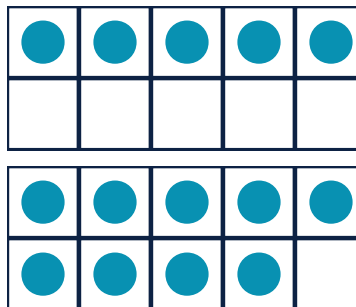
- 1 Write your name at the top.
- 2 Trace the words. Say each one out loud.
- 3 Count and write the number.
- 4 Color the picture if you finish.

1. Trace and say

ship chin that

2. Count

How many counters? Write the number in the box.



3. FINISHED?

Draw a mitten in the space at the bottom. Give it a pattern.

COLOR ME

Finish early? Color Nell's lost mitten and give it a pattern.



Read Aloud: The Lost Mitten

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD. KEEP THIS PAGE.

HOW TO READ IT

Children sit on the carpet. Read slowly. The **orange boxes** are places to stop and ask the question printed in them. Take two or three answers, then carry on. Do not stop anywhere else, however many hands go up.

The Lost Mitten

Read-aloud story

Nell had two red mittens. Her grandma made them. They had a white star on the back of each one.

On Monday, Nell came home with one mitten.

She looked in her bag. She looked in her boot. She looked under her bed, which was silly, because she had not been under her bed all day.

STOP AND ASK

Where do you think the mitten is?

On Tuesday, Nell walked to school very slowly, looking at the ground the whole way. She found a bottle top, a key and a very flat leaf. She did not find her mitten.

On Wednesday she put up a sign on the school fence. It said: **LOST. ONE RED MITTEN. HAS A STAR.** Underneath she drew a picture, because some of the little ones could not read yet.

On Thursday, nothing happened at all.

STOP AND ASK

How is Nell feeling by Thursday? How can you tell?

On Friday morning there was something on top of the fence post. It was her mitten. It was clean and dry and somebody had sewn the little hole in the thumb.

There was a note. It said: **I found this in the park. My grandma fixed it. She says hello to your grandma.**

Nell never found out who left it. She looked around the playground at all the faces and any one of them could have been the one.

So she was extra kind to everybody, all day, just in case.

STOP AND ASK

Was that a good way to say thank you? Why?



1 Draw the part you liked best.

2 Finish the sentence underneath.

DRAW YOUR FAVORITE PART



Finish this sentence

I think the mitten was found by

TALK ABOUT IT

Turn to the person next to you. Tell them about a time you lost something. Did you find it?





- 1 Say each word out loud.
- 2 Circle the ones with the sound at the top.
- 3 Write two of your own on the lines.

TODAY'S SOUND

sh ch th

Two letters, one sound. Say each word and listen at the start.

Circle the words with the sound

shop

sun

chip

think

top

shell

chair

cat

thumb

Now write two of your own

FAST FINISHER

Sort your circled words into three lists: **sh**, **ch** and **th**. Which list is longest?



1 Look at the words you can use.

2 Say your sentence out loud first.

3 Then write it on the lines.

TODAY YOU ARE WRITING

Somebody was kind to Nell without telling her who they were. Write about a time somebody was kind to you, or a time you were kind to somebody else.

Words you might need

kind

helped

found

because

happy

thank

friend

then

A sentence to start you off

One day somebody was kind to me when



- 1 Draw your picture first.
- 2 Then write two or three sentences about it.
- 3 Check you used a capital letter and a full stop.

YOUR PICTURE

**BEFORE YOU HAND IT IN**

Point at your capital letter. Point at your full stop. Read your sentence out loud to someone at your table.

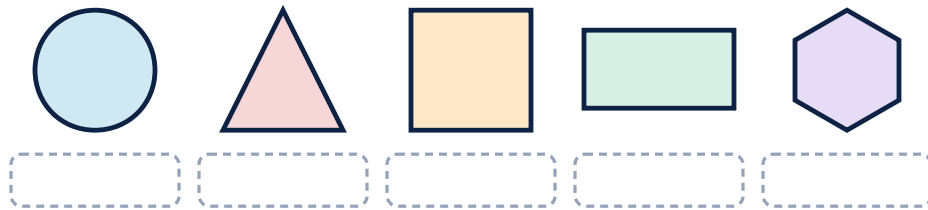




Math: Shapes All Around

SUBSTITUTE: READ THIS PART OUT LOUD

Every shape has a name and a number of sides. Today we are going to name them, count their sides, and then use them to make a pattern. Mittens have patterns on them, like Nell's star.

Shapes All Around

Write the name under each shape in the dotted box.

IF A CHILD IS STUCK

Ask them to trace the shape in the air with one finger and count out loud as they turn each corner. The number of corners is the number of sides.

Try these two together

A. How many sides does a triangle have?

B. How many corners does a square have?

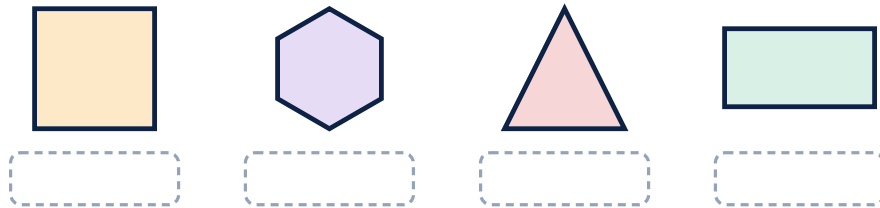


1 Do them in order.

2 Use the pictures to help you.

3 Check your answers by counting again.

1. Count the sides. Write the number in the box.



2. Finish the pattern

Draw what comes next in each row.

circle	square	circle	?
triangle	triangle	square	?

3. Make your own pattern

DRAW A PATTERN USING TWO SHAPES



MATH GAME

HOW TO PLAY

Play with a partner. You need this page and something to point with.

Shape Hunt

1. Player one names a shape out loud.
2. Player two finds that shape somewhere in the room and points at it.
3. If they find one, they tick a box below.
4. Swap. Play until one of you has five ticks.



Write down three shapes you found and where

FAST FINISHER

Find something in the room that has more than six sides. Draw it and count the sides.



**SUBSTITUTE: READ THIS OUT LOUD TOGETHER**

Read one numbered part at a time. Ask the question at the end of each before moving on.

1. Nell's mittens were made of wool. Wool is good at keeping hands warm. A mitten made of paper would not work at all, and a mitten made of metal would be worse.

Ask: why would a paper mitten be no good?

2. Here is the surprising part. Wool is not warm. If you leave a woolly hat on a chair all night, in the morning it is exactly as cold as the chair.

Ask: so where does the warm come from?

3. The warm comes from **you**. Your body makes heat all the time. A good material is one that stops that heat escaping, so it stays near your skin instead of drifting away.

Ask: what happens to your hands when you take your mittens off outside?

4. Wool works because it is full of tiny pockets of trapped air, and air is very bad at carrying heat. Feathers do the same job in a bird and in a puffy coat. Metal is the opposite: it carries heat away fast, which is why a metal gate feels colder than a wooden one even though they are both outside.

Ask: touch your desk and then touch something metal. Do they really have different temperatures?



- 1 Look at the four materials in the boxes.
- 2 Tick the ones that would make a good mitten.
- 3 Draw your own mitten at the bottom and label what it is made of.

MATERIAL	GOOD MITTEN?	WHY DO YOU THINK THAT?
Wool		
Paper		
Metal		
Feathers		

DESIGN YOUR OWN MITTEN

My mitten is made of

FAST FINISHER

Look at what you are wearing right now. Which part of it is best at keeping you warm? Draw it and say why.



- 1 Color the face that shows how today felt.
- 2 Draw one thing you did today.
- 3 Write your name so your teacher knows it is yours.

Great
day

Good
day

Tricky
day

One thing I did today

DRAW IT HERE



My name



Answer Key: Literacy

WORD WORK

Circle: shop, chip, think, shell, chair, thumb. Not circled: sun, top, cat. Those start with one letter, one sound.

Own words: Any real word containing the sound. Invented spelling is fine at this age as long as the sound is there.

READ-ALOUD AND WRITING

Question 1: Open. Every guess is a good guess. Take three and move on quickly.

Question 2: Look for: sad, giving up, disappointed. Then ask *how can you tell?* The answer is that nothing happened at all on Thursday, and the story gives it a whole line to itself.

Question 3: Open. Strong answers: she could not thank one person so she thanked everyone; being kind is a way of saying thank you; the person would know it was for them.

MARKING THE WRITING IN TEN SECONDS

Look for three things and nothing else: a capital letter at the start, a full stop at the end, and a sentence that makes sense when read aloud.

Do not correct spelling. At this age, invented spelling that can be sounded out is exactly what should be happening, and correcting it stops children writing.

What good looks like in grades 1 and 2

	WORKING	NOT YET
Word work	Hears the sound in a word said aloud, even if the spelling is wrong	Circles by looking at the letters only, without saying the word
Writing	One clear sentence that makes sense read aloud	A list of words with no sentence, or a copied stem
Drawing	The picture matches what they wrote	The picture and the writing are about different things
Talking	Can retell one thing that happened in the story	Retells a different story, or their own news

IF A CHILD PRODUCED NOTHING AT ALL

Do not push. Write their name on the sheet, note one line on the substitute's page at the back, and move on. A child who freezes with a stranger in the room is telling you something, and it is not about the task.

Answer Key: Math and Afternoon

MATH

	ANSWER
Names	circle, triangle, square, rectangle, hexagon
Try A	3 sides
Try B	4 corners
Sides	square 4, hexagon 6, triangle 3, rectangle 4
Pattern 1	square. The pattern is circle, square, circle, square.
Pattern 2	triangle. The pattern is triangle, triangle, square, repeating.
Own pattern	Any repeating pattern using two shapes. It must repeat to count.

Game: Open. Common finds: clock (circle), window (rectangle), book (rectangle), roof in a picture (triangle), pencil end (hexagon). Praise anyone who finds a hexagon, since they are genuinely harder to spot.

AFTERNOON

Tick: **Wool** and **feathers** are good. **Paper** tears and lets heat straight through. **Metal** carries heat away from your hand fast.

Part 2 question: The warmth comes from your own body, not from the wool. This surprises children and it is the point of the whole lesson.

Part 4 question: They are the same temperature. Metal only *feels* colder because it pulls heat out of your hand faster. Do not expect children to say this unprompted; tell them, and let them test it.

LEAVE THIS FOR THE TEACHER

Stack the day's work on the desk with the How Was Today? sheets on top. Those tell the returning teacher more in four minutes than any of the work does.

Day 3 at a Glance

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE ON YOUR DESK

THE WHOLE DAY, IN ONE TABLE

Times are a guide. Your school's bells win. The **Page** column tells you which sheet the children need in front of them.

Blocks are short on purpose. Children this age concentrate for about as many minutes as their age. Every block here is under thirty, and there is a movement break between most of them.

TIME	BLOCK	WHAT HAPPENS	PAGE
8:30	Arrival	Children come in and start Morning Work. Take attendance while they work.	p. 42
8:45	Carpet time	Read the script on the next page. Teach your quiet signal now.	keep
9:00	Read aloud	Read the story on the carpet. Stop at the orange boxes.	keep
9:20	After the story	Children draw and finish a sentence.	p. 44
9:40	Movement break	Two minutes. Use the Brain Breaks page.	back
9:45	Word work	Rhyming families. Circle, then write.	p. 45
10:10	Recess	Ask a child where the class lines up.	—
10:30	Writing	How to plant a seed. Two pages.	p. 46-47
11:05	Math	Measuring and comparing. Teaching page, then practice.	p. 48-49
11:40	Math game	Partners. Ten minutes.	p. 50
12:00	Lunch	Line them up three minutes early.	—
12:50	Quiet time	Children look at books at their desks.	—
1:10	Afternoon	Read the science page aloud together, then the task.	p. 51-52
1:50	Specials or filler	If there is no special, use the Time Filler Bank.	back
2:30	Closing	How Was Today? sheet, then pack up.	p. 53
2:50	Dismissal	Stack all work on the desk with the closing sheets on top.	—

IF YOU ARE RUNNING BEHIND

Cut the math game and quiet time first. The writing block usually runs long on this day and that is fine.

THE SINGLE MOST USEFUL THING YOU CAN DO

Say what is happening next, out loud, before every change. "When I count to five we are putting pencils down and coming to the carpet." Children this age are not being difficult at transitions. They genuinely do not know what is coming.

Carpet Time and First Moves

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE

THE FIRST FIFTEEN MINUTES DECIDE THE DAY

You are a stranger and they will check what the rules are with you. Being warm and completely predictable is worth more than being strict.

On the carpet, ten minutes

SAY THIS TO START

Good morning everyone. My name is on the board. Your teacher is away today and left me a plan for the whole day. First, my quiet signal. I clap like this and you clap it back. Let us practice. Good. This morning we have a story about a seed that got impatient, some writing, and some measuring. This afternoon we find out what a plant actually needs. Help me with your names.

Then, in this order

WHAT YOU DO	
1	Write your name on the board. Point at it and say it.
2	Teach the clap-back signal and practice it twice now.
3	Read the script above exactly.
4	Ask: <i>what does this class always do at carpet time?</i> Two answers only.
5	Say what happens before recess, on your fingers.
6	Start the read-aloud while they are settled.

Four things that work with this age

INSTEAD OF	TRY
"Be quiet!"	"Show me listening ears." Then wait. Do not repeat it.
"Sit down."	"Bottoms on the carpet, hands in your lap, eyes on me." Say all three.
"Who did that?"	"I am waiting for one more person." Never name a child in front of the class.
"Stop it."	"That is not a safe choice. Show me a safe choice." Then praise the child who does.

YOUR QUIET SIGNAL

Teach one in the first ten minutes and use it all day. A clap-back pattern works everywhere: you clap a short rhythm, they clap it back. Practice it once while everyone is calm and it will work when they are not.



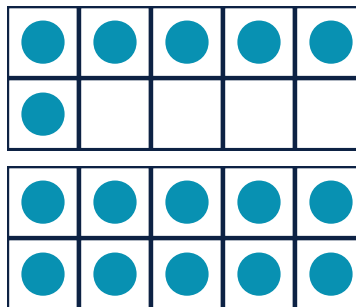
- 1 Write your name at the top.
- 2 Trace the words. Say each one out loud.
- 3 Count and write the number.
- 4 Color the picture if you finish.

1. Trace and say

seed rain grow

2. Count

How many counters? Write the number in the box.



3. FINISHED?

Draw a plant at the bottom. Show the roots under the ground.

COLOR ME

Finish early? Color the little plant and add a sun.



Read Aloud: The Seed That Would Not Wait

SUBSTITUTE • READ THIS OUT LOUD. KEEP THIS PAGE.

HOW TO READ IT

Children sit on the carpet. Read slowly. The **orange boxes** are places to stop and ask the question printed in them. Take two or three answers, then carry on. Do not stop anywhere else, however many hands go up.

The Seed That Would Not Wait

Read-aloud story

Down in the dark, under the soil, a small seed was waking up.

"It is time," said the seed. "I can feel it. It is warm and it is wet and it is time to grow."

"Not yet," said the old root beside her. "Wait. There is still frost up there."

But the seed did not want to wait. She pushed. She pushed again. A tiny green shoot came out of the top of her and started climbing.

STOP AND ASK

What do you think will happen when she gets to the top?

Up she went, through the dark soil, past a stone, past a worm, until at last her little green head came out into the air.

It was freezing.

The wind pushed her one way and then the other. There was no sun at all, only a grey sky. And that night the frost came and her leaves went soft and brown at the edges.

"I told you," said the old root, but kindly.

STOP AND ASK

How is the seed feeling now? Show me with your face.

The little plant did not die. She stayed very still and very small. She kept her roots deep and she waited, which is what she should have done in the first place.

Three weeks later the sun came out properly. The soil went warm all the way down. And all around her, hundreds of other shoots came pushing up out of the ground, all at once, all together.

She was the tallest of all of them, because she had started first.

"Well," said the old root. "Perhaps you knew something after all."

STOP AND ASK

Was the seed right to go early, or wrong? Why?



1 Draw the part you liked best.

2 Finish the sentence underneath.

DRAW YOUR FAVORITE PART



Finish this sentence

I think the seed was

TALK ABOUT IT

Turn to the person next to you. Tell them about a time you did not want to wait for something.





Word Work: -ain and -ake

- 1 Say each word out loud.
- 2 Circle the ones with the sound at the top.
- 3 Write two of your own on the lines.

TODAY'S SOUND

-ain and -ake

Words that rhyme often end with the same letters. Say each one and listen to the end.

Circle the words with the sound

rain

cake

run

make

chain

cat

train

shake

sock

Now write two of your own

FAST FINISHER

Write two more words that rhyme with **rain**, and two more that rhyme with **cake**. Made-up words do not count.





1 Look at the words you can use.

2 Say your sentence out loud first.

3 Then write it on the lines.

TODAY YOU ARE WRITING

Instructions. Tell somebody **how to plant a seed** so that it grows. Somebody who has never done it before.

Words you might need

first

next

then

last

soil

water

sun

seed

A sentence to start you off

First you



- 1 Draw your picture first.
- 2 Then write two or three sentences about it.
- 3 Check you used a capital letter and a full stop.

YOUR PICTURE

**BEFORE YOU HAND IT IN**

Point at your capital letter. Point at your full stop. Read your sentence out loud to someone at your table.





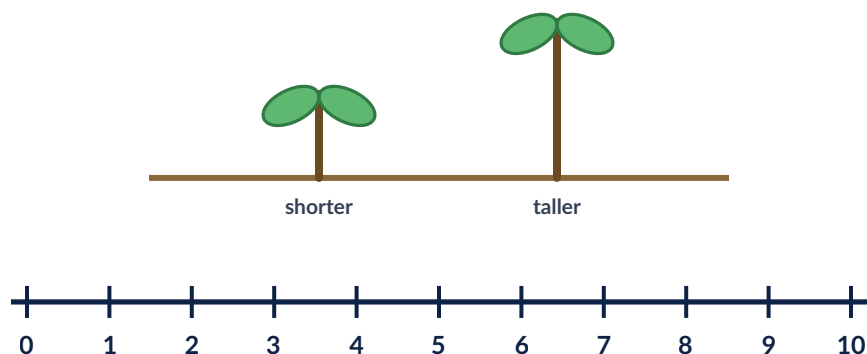
Math: Which Is Taller?

SUBSTITUTE: READ THIS PART OUT LOUD

We are going to measure plants. We are not going to use a ruler today. We are going to use cubes, because a plant is a funny shape and cubes are easier to count.

Which Is Taller?

Each plant is measured in cubes. Count the cubes and write the number.



Plant A = 4 cubes Plant B = 7 cubes

So plant B is taller. How much taller? Count on from 4 to 7. That is 3 cubes.

$$7 - 4 = 3$$

IF A CHILD IS STUCK

Get them to put a finger on the smaller number on the number line and hop up to the bigger one, counting hops out loud. The hops are the answer.

Try these two together

A. Plant C is 6 cubes. Plant D is 9 cubes. Which is taller?

☐ C

☐ D

☐ same

B. How much taller?

☐ 2

☐ 3

☐ 4



1 Do them in order.

2 Use the pictures to help you.

3 Check your answers by counting again.

1. Write which is taller, and by how much.

PLANT 1	PLANT 2	WHICH IS TALLER?	BY HOW MUCH?
3 cubes	8 cubes		
10 cubes	6 cubes		
5 cubes	5 cubes		
9 cubes	2 cubes		

2. Order them

Write these from shortest to tallest: 7, 2, 9, 4

3. Measure something real

Find something on your desk. How many cubes long is it? If you have no cubes, use your fingers.



MATH GAME

HOW TO PLAY

Play with a partner. You need this page and your hands.

Taller or Shorter

1. Player one points at something in the room.
2. Player two points at something they think is **taller**.
3. Both check by standing next to them.
4. If player two was right, they tick a box. Then swap.

✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
---	---	---	---	---

Write down two things you compared

FAST FINISHER

Find the shortest thing in the room that you are allowed to pick up. Then find the tallest thing you can reach. Draw both.





Science: What a Plant Needs

SUBSTITUTE: READ THIS OUT LOUD TOGETHER

Read one numbered part at a time. Ask the question at the end of each before moving on.

1. Our seed came up too early and got frosted. She was missing something a plant has to have. Today we find out what plants actually need.

Ask: what do you think a plant needs?

2. A plant needs **water**. It drinks through its roots, which is why the roots are under the ground where the water is.

Ask: what happens to a plant nobody waters?

3. A plant needs **light**. Leaves use sunlight to make food. That is why a plant on a windowsill leans over toward the window.

Ask: have you ever seen a plant leaning like that?

4. A plant needs **warmth**. Seeds stay asleep in cold soil and wake up when it warms. That is exactly what the old root in our story was trying to tell the seed.

Ask: why did the frost hurt her leaves?

5. A plant needs **air** and **space** too. Plants packed too close together fight each other for the light, and none of them do well.

Ask: what would happen if you planted a hundred seeds in one small pot?



Science: What a Plant Needs: Your Turn

- 1 Look at the four pots at the top.
- 2 Circle the one that will grow best.
- 3 Draw what a plant needs in the four boxes.

No water
Sun

Water
No light

Water
Sun

No water
No light

Draw the four things a plant needs

WATER	LIGHT
WARMTH	SPACE

A plant needs light because

FAST FINISHER

Draw the plant from our story three weeks later, when the sun came out. Show her roots, her leaves and the other shoots around her.



- 1 Color the face that shows how today felt.
- 2 Draw one thing you did today.
- 3 Write your name so your teacher knows it is yours.

Great
day

Good
day

Tricky
day

One thing I did today

DRAW IT HERE



My name



Answer Key: Literacy

WORD WORK

Circle: rain, cake, make, chain, train, shake. Not circled: run, cat, sock.

Own words: Any real word containing the sound. Invented spelling is fine at this age as long as the sound is there.

READ-ALOUD AND WRITING

Question 1: Open. Take three predictions and move on.

Question 2: Cold, sad, sorry, embarrassed. Faces are fine as an answer at this age; ask one child to say a word for it.

Question 3: Open, and genuinely two-sided. She was hurt by the frost, but she ended up tallest because she started first. Accept either answer with a reason. If the class splits, that is the best possible outcome.

MARKING THE WRITING IN TEN SECONDS

Look for three things and nothing else: a capital letter at the start, a full stop at the end, and a sentence that makes sense when read aloud.

Do not correct spelling. At this age, invented spelling that can be sounded out is exactly what should be happening, and correcting it stops children writing.

What good looks like in grades 1 and 2

	WORKING	NOT YET
Word work	Hears the sound in a word said aloud, even if the spelling is wrong	Circles by looking at the letters only, without saying the word
Writing	One clear sentence that makes sense read aloud	A list of words with no sentence, or a copied stem
Drawing	The picture matches what they wrote	The picture and the writing are about different things
Talking	Can retell one thing that happened in the story	Retells a different story, or their own news

IF A CHILD PRODUCED NOTHING AT ALL

Do not push. Write their name on the sheet, note one line on the substitute's page at the back, and move on. A child who freezes with a stranger in the room is telling you something, and it is not about the task.

Answer Key: Math and Afternoon

MATH

	ANSWER
Try A	D is taller
Try B	3 cubes
3 v 8	Plant 2, by 5
10 v 6	Plant 1, by 4
5 v 5	Neither, they are the same
9 v 2	Plant 1, by 7
Order	2, 4, 7, 9
Measure	Open. Any sensible number with a named object.

Game: Open. The useful bit is that children check by standing things side by side, which is the whole idea of comparing length directly.

AFTERNOON

Circle: The third pot: **water and sun**. It is the only one with both.

Sentence: Look for the idea that leaves use light to make food, or simply that plants need light to grow. Do not correct spelling.

Part 4 question: The frost froze the water inside her leaves, which damaged them. At this age "it was too cold for her" is a full-credit answer.

Part 5 question: They would fight for light and water and none of them would grow well.

LEAVE THIS FOR THE TEACHER

Stack the day's work on the desk with the How Was Today? sheets on top. Those tell the returning teacher more in four minutes than any of the work does.

Time Filler Bank

SUBSTITUTE • KEEP THIS PAGE. YOU WILL NEED IT.

WHY THIS PAGE EXISTS

An infant day is full of gaps: five minutes before specials, ten because lunch ran late, the wait while thirty children put their coats on. Those gaps are where a class you do not know falls apart.

Nothing below needs any equipment at all.

Under three minutes

ACTIVITY	HOW IT WORKS
Simon says	Never fails at this age. Speed it up to make it harder. You can play it in a line waiting for the bell.
Copy my clap	You clap a rhythm, they clap it back. Make it longer each time. Doubles as your quiet signal.
Head, shoulders, knees	Sing it. Then sing it faster. Then sing it missing out one body part.
Silent count to ten	The class counts to ten, one number per child, nobody chosen and no two speaking at once. Start again on a clash. Absorbing and very quiet.
I spy	Use the first sound, not the letter name. "I spy something starting with mmm." That makes it phonics.

Three to ten minutes

ACTIVITY	HOW IT WORKS
The rhyming game	You say a word. Go round the circle adding rhymes. Made-up words are allowed and make it funnier.
What is missing?	Put five things on a table. Children close their eyes. Take one away. What has gone?
Story chain	You start a story with one sentence. Each child adds one sentence around the circle. Absurd is fine.
Guess my animal	You think of an animal. They ask yes or no questions. Cap it at ten questions and count them out loud.
Number of the day	Pick a number under 20. Children say everything they know about it: one more, one less, how to make it, what it looks like on fingers.
Draw what I say	Describe a simple picture out loud. They draw it without seeing it. Compare at the end. Very funny and it teaches listening.
Freeze dance, no music	You clap a beat, they move. You stop, they freeze. Needs nothing.

TWO RULES FOR ANY OF THESE

Say how it ends before it starts, and do not offer a choice. Pick one, announce it, run it. Asking thirty six-year-olds what they would like to play turns a calm five minutes into a difficult fifteen.

Brain Breaks and Transitions

SUBSTITUTE · KEEP THIS PAGE

USE ONE EVERY TWENTY MINUTES, NOT WHEN IT GOES WRONG

Children this age concentrate for roughly as many minutes as their age, plus a little. A break every twenty minutes is not lost time. It is what buys you the next twenty.

Signs you needed one five minutes ago: chairs tipping, three bathroom requests in a row, or the same question asked twice.

At their seats, one minute

BREAK	WHAT TO DO
Ten and ten	Ten shoulder rolls back, ten forward. Everyone stays seated.
Sky and toes	Reach to the sky for five, touch your toes for five. Repeat three times.
Five big breaths	In through the nose for four, out through the mouth for six. Genuinely calms a room before writing.
Cross-body taps	Right hand to left knee, left hand to right knee, twenty times. Crossing the midline really does help them refocus.

Standing up, two to three minutes

BREAK	WHAT TO DO
Animal moves	Hop like a frog, stretch like a cat, stomp like an elephant. Ten seconds each. They will suggest more.
Four corners	Name the corners one to four. Call a number, everyone moves. Call them faster.
Popcorn	Everyone crouches. You call names, and each child pops up and back down. Speed up.
Follow the leader	You lead a march around the room and back to the carpet. Excellent for moving a class somewhere without a queue.
Shake it out	Shake one hand for eight, other hand for eight, one foot, other foot. Then four, then two, then one.

GETTING THEM BACK

Always say how it ends before it starts. "When I clap twice we are sitting down ready." A break without a stated ending is just noise you now have to fix.

Wet Weather Bank

SUBSTITUTE • FOR THE DAY IT RAINS

INDOOR RECESS IS THE HARDEST PART OF AN INFANT COVER DAY

They expect free time, you do not know the rules, and the room is not built for it. Pick **one** activity, announce it clearly, and run it for the whole period. Offering choices is what turns wet play into chaos.

Whole class, no equipment

GAME	HOW IT WORKS
Sleeping lions	Everyone lies still. You walk around. Anyone who moves or giggles sits up and helps you spot the others. Buys you fifteen quiet minutes and they never tire of it.
Heads down, thumbs up	Four children are chosen. Everyone else puts heads down, thumb up. The four each press one thumb. Those chosen guess who picked them.
The detective game	One child leaves. The class picks a leader who starts actions everyone copies. The detective returns and works out who is leading.
Corners	Number the corners. Call a number. Anyone in that corner sits down. Last standing wins.
Simon says tournament	Same game, but out means sitting down and helping you spot mistakes. Runs twenty minutes.

At desks, quieter

- **Draw your bedroom** from above, looking down. Harder and more absorbing than it sounds.
- **Roll and draw.** No dice? Children pick a number one to six, and you call one out. Each number is a body part to add to a monster.
- **Name that pattern.** Draw a repeating pattern on the board and children copy it and continue it.
- **Partner drawing.** One child draws a shape, the partner turns it into a picture.

TWO RULES TO STATE AT THE START

Everyone stays in the room, and when you clap the game stops instantly. Say both before you start, not after something goes wrong.

Fast Finisher Menu

COPY THIS PAGE FOR CHILDREN

1 Pick any box.**2** You do not need to ask.**3** Use the back of your sheet.**TRY THIS**

- 1 Draw your favorite animal. Label three parts of it.
- 2 Write your name using only capital letters. Then only small letters. Which was harder?
- 3 Draw a picture of the story we read today. Put yourself in it.
- 4 Find five things in the room that are round. Draw them.
- 5 Count how many chairs are in the room. Write the number. Count again to check.
- 6 Write three words that rhyme with **cat**.
- 7 Draw a machine that would tidy your bedroom for you.
- 8 Write a sentence about what you will do after school.
- 9 Draw a map of your classroom. Show the door and the carpet.
- 10 Draw something you are good at.

SPACE TO WORK**STILL FINISHED?**

Look at a book quietly, or help someone at your table. Helping means asking them a question, not doing it for them.

Substitute's Note Back

SUBSTITUTE • FILL THIS IN BEFORE YOU LEAVE

THREE THINGS, THEN YOU ARE DONE

1. Stack the day's work on the desk with the How Was Today? sheets on top.
2. Name two or three children who genuinely helped. Teachers act on this and the children find out.
3. Write one line about anything the teacher should know. One line.

NOTE BACK TO THE TEACHER

My name

Day taught

Day 1 / Day 2 / Day 3

We got through

All of it / Most of it / The morning only

What we did not reach

Children who helped

Anyone upset or unwell

Anything else

One line is plenty

Would I come back?

Yes, gladly / Yes / Probably not, because:

A NOTE TO THE RETURNING TEACHER

The most useful thing in the pile is not the worksheets. It is the stack of How Was Today? sheets, where each child has colored a face and drawn one thing they did. Read those first. They take four minutes and they will tell you more about the day than any of the work.

COMMON CORE AND NGSS • GRADES 1-2

Each block is mapped to its primary standard. Standards are given at grade 1 and apply with light adjustment across both grades.

DAY	BLOCK	FOCUS	STANDARD
1	Read aloud	Listening comprehension, retell, prediction	RL.1.1, RL.1.2, SL.1.2
1	Word work	Long vowel team ea	RF.1.3, RF.1.2
1	Writing	Personal narrative sentence	W.1.3
1	Math	Number bonds to ten	1.OA.C.6, 1.OA.D.8
1	Science	Animals and seasonal change	1-LS1-1
2	Read aloud	Character feelings and evidence	RL.1.3, SL.1.2
2	Word work	Consonant digraphs sh, ch, th	RF.1.3
2	Writing	Writing about an experience	W.1.3
2	Math	2D shapes, sides and repeating patterns	1.G.A.1, 1.G.A.2
2	Science	Properties of materials	2-PS1-1, 2-PS1-2
3	Read aloud	Cause and effect, forming an opinion	RL.1.1, SL.1.1
3	Word work	Rhyming word families	RF.1.2, RF.1.3
3	Writing	Procedural writing with sequence words	W.1.2
3	Math	Comparing and ordering length	1.MD.A.1, 1.MD.A.2
3	Science	What plants need to grow	2-LS2-1

Also practiced every day

- Letter formation, through the tracing and handwriting lines
- Counting and number recognition, through the morning ten frames
- Speaking and listening, through the carpet discussion and turn-and-talk prompts
- Self-assessment, through the How Was Today? sheet

A NOTE ON STANDARDS

These are complete instructional days, not curriculum coverage. They are designed to be genuinely useful on a day the regular teacher is absent, without depending on where a class has reached in its own program. Every day stands alone.

This resource is independently created and is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or reviewed by any state agency or standards body.

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THANK YOU

Thank you for buying this pack. It was written by a practicing teacher with more than twenty years in classrooms, and built the way I would want a full day of infant cover built if I were the one waking up sick at half past five.

If it saved you a morning, a rating on the listing genuinely helps other teachers find it, and earns you credit toward your next purchase.

Getting the most out of this pack

- **Print all three days before you need them.** The whole point is that it works on a morning when you cannot get to school to print anything.
- **Copy each day as one stapled packet.** Eleven student pages. Handing out one packet removes most of the transitions where an infant class comes apart.
- **Keep the five substitute pages in order on the desk.** Day at a Glance, carpet script, read-aloud story, two answer keys.
- **Fill in the Class Information page once,** at the start of the year.
- **Use the filler banks when you are present too.** The brain breaks and wet weather pages work on any Tuesday.

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You may: print this pack for your own classroom, as many times as you like, for as many years as you like. Photocopy the student pages freely for your own children and leave the pack for a substitute covering your own class.

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Credits

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